

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

CANDIDATE SURNAME

OTHER NAMES

CENTRE NUMBER

CANDIDATE NUMBER

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

HISTORY · PAPER 3: MODERN DEPTH STUDY

Time: 1 hour 20 minutes (Complete Mock) · 52 Marks (+4 SPaG)

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Key Topic 1: The Development of the Civil Rights Movement, 1954–60

Comprehensive 12-Page Specification Practice Pack · 1954–1960

PAPER
REFERENCE

1H10/33

Instructions: Use black ink or ball-point pen. Fill in candidate details above.

- Answer ALL questions in Section A (Question 1 and Question 2).
- Answer ALL questions in Section B (Question 3(a), 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)).
- Read the Section B Historical Enquiry Dossier carefully on Page 5 before attempting Questions 3(a)–(d).

TOTAL MARKS

56

(52 + 4 SPaG)

Advice: Spend approx. 15 minutes on Section A Q1–Q2, and 60 minutes on Section B Q3(a)–(d). **SPaG:** 4 marks are awarded for spelling, punctuation, grammar, and specialist terms on Q3(d).

Q	TYPE	SPECIFICATION TOPIC FOCUS	PAGE	MARKS	AUDIT
SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER (COMPULSORY QUESTION 1 & QUESTION 2)					
Q1	INFERENCE	Source A: Jim Crow Railway Sign (Jacksonville, FL)	P2	[4]	☐ / 4
Q2	EXPLAIN WHY	Obstacles to Southern Black Voter Registration (Early 1950s)	P3–4	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & INTERPRETATIONS (INTEGRATED 36M + 4 SPAG)					
Dossier	ENQUIRY	Dossier: Montgomery Bus Boycott (Sources B, C & Ints 1, 2)	P5	Dossier	☐ / Read
3 (a)	UTILITY	Sources B & C: Reasons for Success of Montgomery Boycott	P6	[8]	☐ / 8
3 (b)	DIFFERENCE	Interpretations 1 & 2: Main Difference in Views on Boycott	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (c)	REASON	Interpretations 1 & 2: Reasons for Difference in Historical Views	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (d)	ESSAY	Evaluative Essay: How Far Do You Agree with Interpretation 1?	P8–9	[20]	☐ / 20
4	DEPTH BOOSTER	Spec Depth: Why Brown v. Board Met Intense Resistance	P10	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION C: GRADE 8/9 STANDARDS & EXAM TRAPS (SELF & PEER ASSESSMENT)					
Exemplars	SECTION A MODELS	Full Level 2 Model Q1 & Level 4 Model Q2 Essay + Examiner Marks	P11	Audit	☐ Verified
Exemplars	SECTION B MODELS	Full Level 3 Model Q3a, Q3b, Q3c & Level 4 Q3d Model + Top 3 Traps	P12	Audit	☐ Verified

Source A: Segregated Municipal Railway Waiting Room, Jacksonville, Florida, early 1950s

US National Archives • Record Group 21 / Southern Railway Photographic Records

A large, prominently displayed painted sign affixed to the brick exterior of the terminal above the entrance door reads:

"WAITING ROOM FOR COLORED ONLY BY ORDER POLICE DEPT. All colored passengers must purchase tickets at the window marked Colored and enter cars from the rear platform. Loitering on the white concourse is strictly forbidden under penalty of fine or imprisonment."

Provenance: Official photograph taken for the Jacksonville Municipal Transportation Authority, Florida, documenting Jim Crow signage at the railway terminal.

1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about racial segregation in the American South in the early 1950s. (4)

(I) INFERENCE 1:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(II) INFERENCE 2:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

Candidate Response Lines:

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Spend approx. 15 minutes on Question 2. Construct three developed causal paragraphs.

Q2: CAUSATION ESSAY [12M]

2 Explain why it was difficult for Black Americans in the Southern states to register to vote in the early 1950s. (12)

(You must also use information of your own.)

15th Amendment bypassed Poll taxes Impossible literacy questions
All-white registrars KKK lynchings & cross burnings White Citizens' Councils evictions
Fewer than 20% registered in South

A fundamental obstacle was... Furthermore, ...

This was reinforced by... Consequently, ... As a result, ...

Paragraph 1 Focus: Paragraph 1: Legal & Bureaucratic Barriers — Unfair literacy tests and poll taxes enforced arbitrarily by all-white registrars.

[illegible]

Complete Paragraph 2 and Paragraph 3 (Compulsory Own Knowledge).

Q2: CONTINUATION

Paragraph 3 Focus (Compulsory Own Knowledge): Paragraph 3: Economic Coercion (Own Knowledge) — White Citizens' Councils firing activists, canceling mortgages, and evicting sharecroppers.

[illegible]

☐ 3 Developed Causal Factors ☐ Beyond Stimulus Own Fact ☐ Explicit Connectives ☐ Sustained Analytical Focus

SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY DOSSIER

Read this archival dossier carefully. All questions in Section B (Questions 3a–3d) relate to these materials.

HISTORICAL ENQUIRY FOCUS: THE REASONS FOR THE SUCCESS OF THE MONTGOMERY BUS BOYCOTT (1955–56) PAPER 3 · SECTION B

Source B: From a protest flyer mimeographed and distributed in Montgomery, 2 December 1955

Alabama Department of Archives and History

"Another woman has been arrested and thrown into jail because she refused to get up out of her seat on the bus for a white person... This has to be stopped. Negroes have rights too. If Negroes did not ride the buses, they could not operate; three-fourths of the riders are Negroes. We are asking every Negro to stay off the buses on Monday in protest of the arrest and trial. Don't ride the buses to work, to town, to school, or anywhere on Monday. If you must work, take a cab, or share a ride, or walk."

Provenance: Protest leaflet written and mimeographed overnight by Jo Ann Robinson and the Women's Political Council (WPC), distributing 35,000 copies.

Source C: From an address by Dr Martin Luther King Jr. to the Montgomery Improvement Association, 5 December 1955

Martin Luther King Jr. Papers Project

"We are here this evening for serious business. We are here in a general sense because first and foremost we are American citizens, and we are determined to apply our citizenship to the fullness of its meaning... There comes a time when people get tired of being trampled over by the iron feet of oppression. Our method will be that of persuasion, not coercion. We will say to the people: let your conscience be your guide. Our actions must be guided by the highest Christian principles of love and non-violence."

Provenance: Speech delivered by Dr Martin Luther King Jr. at Holt Street Baptist Church to over 5,000 citizens at the first mass rally of the boycott.

Interpretation 1

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Danielle L. McGuire, 'At the Dark End of the Street: Black Women, Rape, and Resistance' (2010):

"The Montgomery Bus Boycott was fundamentally the achievement of organized Black working-class women. Long before national male leaders arrived, Jo Ann Robinson and the Women's Political Council had methodically planned a bus strike. Within hours of Rosa Parks' arrest, Robinson spent the night mimeographing 35,000 leaflets. Over the next 381 days, thousands of domestic maids and cooks walked up to twelve miles a day in freezing winter and blistering summer, while local drivers ran an intricate 300-car dispatch network. It was this daily grassroots courage and economic sacrifice—depriving the bus company of over 70% of its passengers—that brought Montgomery to its knees."

Interpretation 2

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian David L. Lewis, 'King: A Critical Biography' (1970):

"While grassroots logistics sustained the boycott, the movement achieved national momentum and ultimate victory because of the charismatic moral leadership of Dr Martin Luther King Jr. King provided the strategic vision and rhetorical genius that unified disparate local factions and prevented violent retaliation despite firebombings and arrests. He framed the local dispute as a national crusade for Christian justice, attracting essential northern financial support and national media coverage. Crucially, local economic pressure alone could not change municipal segregation laws; success ultimately depended on the legal strategy that secured the Supreme Court's Browder v. Gayle ruling."

Enquiry Core: Source B & C provide contemporary primary evidence; Interpretations 1 & 2 provide competing modern historical views. Keep Page 5 open for Q3(a)–(d)

Spend approx. 12 minutes on Question 3(a). Evaluate content, provenance (COP), and context.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)? (8)

Contextual Knowledge: Mention the 381-day duration, the 300-car pool network, the Browder v. Gayle Supreme Court ruling (Nov 1956), and violent white backlash.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue dashed lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C)

Spend approx. 5 minutes on Q3(b) and 5 minutes on Q3(c). Write in concise, focused prose.

Q3(B) & Q3(C): INTERPRETATIONS [8M]

3 (b) Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main reason why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations. (4)

Direct Contrast Frame: Interpretation 1 argues that... whereas Interpretation 2 argues that...

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3 (c) Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the main reason why the Montgomery Bus Boycott succeeded. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4)

Different Views Frame: The historians give different views because they have relied on different sources/evidence. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which emphasizes... whereas Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which emphasizes...

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Spend approx. 25 minutes on Question 3(d). 16 marks for content + 4 marks for SPaG.

3 (d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 about the reasons for the success of the Montgomery Bus Boycott (1955–56)? (16 + 4 SPaG)

- Points in Int 1 that are valid
- Evidence from Source B supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Alternative counter-argument in Int 2
- Evidence from Source C supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Grassroots economic mobilization (WPC, 300-car pool, walking 381 days, 70% revenue loss)
- Charismatic moral leadership (MLK, non-violence, mass church rallies, national media coverage)
- Federal legal intervention (Supreme Court ruling in *Browder v. Gayle*, 14th Amendment supremacy)

Paragraph 1: Evaluate Interpretation 1 with precise own knowledge → Paragraph 2: Evaluate Interpretation 2 with precise own knowledge.

[illegible]

SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(D) (CONTINUED)

Complete your synthesis and reach a weighed, criteria-based conclusion.

Q3(D): CONCLUSION & JUDGEMENT

Conclusion Rule: State explicitly *how far* you agree using your chosen criteria. Do not merely summarize.

SPaG Check: Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. SCLC, Supreme Court, Vietcong).

[illegible]

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 4 MARK SCHEME [13–16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 17–20 MARKS]:

- ☐
- Both Interpretations Weighed
- ☐
- Extensive Contextual Facts
- ☐
- Sustained Evaluative Criteria
- ☐
- Flawless SPaG & Specialist Terms

Exhaustive specification coverage. Practice an alternative high-yield exam question for this Key Topic.

4 Explain why the Brown v. Board of Education decision (1954) met with intense resistance in the Southern states. (12)

(You must also use information of your own.)

Earl Warren unanimous 9-0 ruling	"Separate is inherently unequal"
101 Southern congressmen	White Citizens' Councils (1954)
101st Airborne Division deployed	Closure of public schools

- **P1:** Southern Political Resistance: The Southern Manifesto signed by 101 congressmen urging states to resist federal tyranny.
- **P2:** State-Level Nullification & Little Rock: Governor Faubus deploying the National Guard to defy federal court desegregation orders.
- **P3:** Community & Economic Backlash (Own Knowledge): White Citizens' Councils intimidating Black parents and closing public schools.

[illegible]

SECTION C: HIGH-SCORING EXEMPLAR RESPONSES • SECTION A

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 & Level 4 continuous prose models with examiner annotations.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q1 & Q2

QUESTION 1: SOURCE INFERENCE EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 2 (4/4)

Give two things you can infer from Source A about racial segregation in the American South in the early 1950s.

(i) What I can infer: I can infer that racial segregation was strictly enforced by official legal authorities rather than just being informal prejudice. Details in the source that tell me this: The source states "BY ORDER POLICE DEPT" and warns that loitering carries a "penalty of fine or imprisonment".

(ii) What I can infer: I can infer that Black Americans were treated as second-class citizens and relegated to inferior, separated facilities in public transport. Details in the source that tell me this: The source states that "All colored passengers must purchase tickets at the window marked Colored and enter cars from the rear platform."

Examiner Annotation: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Two valid inferences made directly from the source, each supported by precise, direct textual quotations.

QUESTION 2: CAUSATION ESSAY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 4 (12/12)

Explain why it was difficult for Black Americans in the Southern states to register to vote in the early 1950s. (12 marks)

A fundamental reason why voter registration was exceedingly difficult was the systematic use of discriminatory literacy tests and poll taxes. Under the doctrine of states' rights, Southern registrars held unchecked authority to administer registration tests. Black applicants were routinely asked impossible, obscure questions—such as reciting complex sections of the state constitution or guessing the number of bubbles in a bar of soap. Poor Black citizens were also subjected to cumulative poll taxes, which intentionally priced impoverished sharecroppers out of democracy. As a result, fewer than 20% of eligible Black adults were registered across the South, and under 5% in rural Mississippi.

Furthermore, voter registration was severely impeded by the constant threat of white supremacist violence and terror. Vigilante groups such as the Ku Klux Klan (KKK) operated with complete judicial impunity across the Deep South. Black citizens who dared to approach registration offices were subjected to violent intimidation, nighttime cross-burnings, house firebombings, and lynchings. Because local police sheriffs were frequently Klan members or sympathizers, Black applicants knew that the law would not protect them, creating a paralyzing climate of fear that suppressed political mobilization.

Finally, registration was blocked by systematic economic coercion orchestrated by the White Citizens' Councils. Founded in 1944, these organizations of middle-class white professionals, bankers, and merchants used economic retaliation against any Black individual attempting to exercise civil rights. Black applicants had their names published in local newspapers, leading immediately to job dismissals, eviction from tenant farms, and the cancellation of bank credit and mortgages. This economic stranglehold ensured that even Black citizens willing to risk physical violence were deterred by the immediate prospect of financial ruin for their families.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (12/12 Marks): Fully developed 3-paragraph causal explanation; integrates both stimulus points alongside substantial own knowledge (White Citizens' Councils); precise historical facts and sustained analytical focus.

QUESTION 3(A): SOURCE UTILITY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 3 (8/8)

Source B is highly useful because it provides direct contemporary evidence of the rapid grassroots mobilization of the Black community. Written by Jo Ann Robinson and distributed by the Women's Political Council on 2 December 1955, the flyer reveals the strategic awareness of Black economic power, pointing out that "three-fourths of the riders are Negroes" and urging an immediate boycott. The utility is enhanced by its provenance: as an authentic working document distributed to 35,000 citizens, it proves that the boycott was organized by local women before national leaders took charge. However, its usefulness is limited as it only reflects the initial call to action, omitting the subsequent 381 days of walking and the 300-car pool network.

Source C is also extremely useful because it provides firsthand insight into the inspirational moral leadership of Dr Martin Luther King Jr. In his 5 December speech, King establishes the core philosophy of Christian non-violence and frames the boycott as a struggle for constitutional citizenship. The provenance makes it particularly valuable: as a speech delivered to 5,000 energized protesters, it shows how King maintained community morale and non-violent discipline despite police harassment and bomb threats. When evaluated together with knowledge that the Supreme Court's *Browder v. Gayle* ruling ultimately outlawed bus segregation in November 1956, both sources are exceptionally useful in demonstrating how grassroots logistics (Source B) and charismatic spiritual leadership (Source C) combined to achieve victory.

Examiner Annotation: Level 3 (8/8 Marks): Sophisticated evaluation of content, provenance (nature, origin, purpose), and contextual knowledge for both sources; weighs usefulness in relation to the specific enquiry.

QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C): INTERPRETATIONS EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 2 (4/4 + 4/4)

Q3(b) Difference: The main difference between the interpretations is that Interpretation 1 views the boycott as the achievement of working-class Black women and grassroots community logistics, whereas Interpretation 2 argues that success was primarily due to Dr Martin Luther King Jr.'s charismatic moral leadership and federal legal intervention. Interpretation 1 emphasizes that Jo Ann Robinson and the WPC organized the 35,000 leaflets and the 381-day walking protest, while Interpretation 2 asserts that King's rhetorical genius gave the movement national visibility and that only the Supreme Court's *Browder v. Gayle* ruling could legally force desegregation.

Q3(c) Reason: Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views because the historians have investigated different aspects of the historical evidence. The author of Interpretation 1 has relied on grassroots documentation such as Source B, focusing on the practical organizing efforts of the Women's Political Council and the economic power of domestic workers. Conversely, the author of Interpretation 2 has focused on high-profile public records and leadership speeches such as Source C, emphasizing Dr King's oratory, the church mass rallies, and the national constitutional legal battle in the federal courts.

Examiner Annotation: Q3b: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Direct, clear contrast of main viewpoints using accurate supporting details from both interpretations. | Q3c: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Explains differing interpretations by linking them explicitly to differing source material and historical emphases.

QUESTION 3(D): EVALUATIVE ESSAY CONCLUSION MODEL

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 4 (16+4 = 20/20)

In conclusion, I agree with Interpretation 1 to a substantial extent, because without the daily sacrifice of thousands of working-class domestic workers and the organizational brilliance of the Women's Political Council, there would have been no boycott for Dr King to lead. The grassroots community sustained the 381-day protest through an intricate 300-car pool network, inflicting devastating financial losses on the municipal bus company. However, Interpretation 1 overstates the case by downplaying the legal and political reality highlighted in Interpretation 2. Economic distress alone could not overturn segregation, as city officials refused to yield despite severe business losses. Ultimate victory required the federal legal mandate of *Browder v. Gayle* (November 1956) and King's moral leadership to attract northern financial support. Therefore, the boycott was a complementary triumph: grassroots courage created the crisis, but federal judicial power and King's national profile sealed the victory.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (16+4 = 20/20 Marks): Sustained, criteria-based historiographical judgement; balances both interpretations with extensive own knowledge; nuanced conclusion weighing grassroots resistance against federal judicial power.

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KEY TOPIC 1

- | | | |
|--|---|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Rosa Parks was NOT an accidental protester
Do not describe Rosa Parks as an exhausted seamstress who simply acted on impulse. She was a seasoned NAACP secretary trained in civil disobedience at the Highlander Folk School. | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Economic pressure alone did NOT desegregate buses
The bus company suffered crippling financial losses, but city ordinances forbade integration. Desegregation occurred strictly because the Supreme Court ruled in <i>Browder v. Gayle</i> that bus segregation violated the 14th Amendment. | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• The Boycott did NOT desegregate Montgomery
The 1956 victory applied strictly to municipal public buses. All other public facilities in Montgomery—schools, restaurants, swimming pools, and waiting rooms—remained fiercely segregated. |
|--|---|--|

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Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

HISTORY · PAPER 3: MODERN DEPTH STUDY

Time: 1 hour 20 minutes (Complete Mock) · 52 Marks (+4 SPaG)

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Key Topic 2: The Radicalisation of the Civil Rights Movement, 1965–68

Comprehensive 12-Page Specification Practice Pack · 1965–1968

PAPER
REFERENCE

1H10/33

Instructions: Use black ink or ball-point pen. Fill in candidate details above.

- Answer ALL questions in Section A (Question 1 and Question 2).
- Answer ALL questions in Section B (Question 3(a), 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)).
- Read the Section B Historical Enquiry Dossier carefully on Page 5 before attempting Questions 3(a)–(d).

TOTAL MARKS

56

(52 + 4 SPaG)

Advice: Spend approx. 15 minutes on Section A Q1–Q2, and 60 minutes on Section B Q3(a)–(d). **SPaG:** 4 marks are awarded for spelling, punctuation, grammar, and specialist terms on Q3(d).

Q	TYPE	SPECIFICATION TOPIC FOCUS	PAGE	MARKS	AUDIT
SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER (COMPULSORY QUESTION 1 & QUESTION 2)					
Q1	INFERENCE	Source A: Birmingham Police Crackdown on Marchers (1963)	P2	[4]	☐ / 4
Q2	EXPLAIN WHY	Passage of the Civil Rights Act of 1964	P3–4	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & INTERPRETATIONS (INTEGRATED 36M + 4 SPAG)					
Dossier	ENQUIRY	Dossier: Northern Urban Riots (Sources B, C & Ints 1, 2)	P5	Dossier	☐ / Read
3 (a)	UTILITY	Sources B & C: Causes of Urban Riots (1965–67)	P6	[8]	☐ / 8
3 (b)	DIFFERENCE	Interpretations 1 & 2: Main Difference in Views on Urban Riots	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (c)	REASON	Interpretations 1 & 2: Reasons for Difference in Historical Views	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (d)	ESSAY	Evaluative Essay: How Far Do You Agree with Interpretation 1?	P8–9	[20]	☐ / 20
4	DEPTH BOOSTER	Spec Depth: Formation of the Black Panther Party (1966)	P10	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION C: GRADE 8/9 STANDARDS & EXAM TRAPS (SELF & PEER ASSESSMENT)					
Exemplars	SECTION A MODELS	Full Level 2 Model Q1 & Level 4 Model Q2 Essay + Examiner Marks	P11	Audit	☐ Verified
Exemplars	SECTION B MODELS	Full Level 3 Model Q3a, Q3b, Q3c & Level 4 Q3d Model + Top 3 Traps	P12	Audit	☐ Verified

SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 1

Spend approx. 5 minutes on Question 1. Answer both parts (i) and (ii).

Q1: SOURCE INFERENCE [4M]

Source A: From an eyewitness dispatch by Southern Christian Leadership Conference (SCLC) activist Fred Shuttlesworth, May 1963

Birmingham Public Library Archives • Civil Rights Digital Collection, File 63-B

"On the orders of Public Safety Commissioner Eugene 'Bull' Connor, police directed high-pressure water hoses directly into crowds of singing high school children marching out of the 16th Street Baptist Church. The streams were powerful enough to strip bark from trees, blast girls against brick walls, and rip clothes from teenagers. When the youths still refused to run, Connor unleashed snarling police attack dogs on leashes, which lunged into the crowds, biting several unarmed boys as parents screamed in terror from the sidewalks."

Provenance: Eyewitness account written by civil rights organizer Reverend Fred Shuttlesworth describing the Children's Crusade in Birmingham, Alabama, May 1963.

1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about the methods used by Southern police against civil rights demonstrators in Birmingham, Alabama (1963). (4)

(I) INFERENCE 1:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(II) INFERENCE 2:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

Candidate Response Lines:

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Spend approx. 15 minutes on Question 2. Construct three developed causal paragraphs.

Q2: CAUSATION ESSAY [12M]

(12)

- **The Birmingham Campaign (1963)**
- **The assassination of President Kennedy (November 1963)**

(You must also use information of your own.)

Bull Connor fire hoses & dogs Televised violence shocked voters
 March on Washington (August 1963) 250,000 peaceful demonstrators
 "I Have a Dream" speech Lyndon B. Johnson legislative mastery
 Broke 54-day Senate filibuster

A decisive catalyst was... Furthermore, ...

This moral momentum was deepened when... Consequently, ...

Ultimately, this led to...

[illegible]

Complete Paragraph 2 and Paragraph 3 (Compulsory Own Knowledge).

Q2: CONTINUATION

Paragraph 3 Focus (Compulsory Own Knowledge): Paragraph 3: March on Washington (Own Knowledge) — 250,000 demonstrators created irresistible public pressure to break the 54-day Southern filibuster.

[illegible]

☐ 3 Developed Causal Factors ☐ Beyond Stimulus Own Fact ☐ Explicit Connectives ☐ Sustained Analytical Focus

SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY DOSSIER

Read this archival dossier carefully. All questions in Section B (Questions 3a–3d) relate to these materials.

HISTORICAL ENQUIRY FOCUS: THE CAUSES OF THE RIOTS IN NORTHERN AND WESTERN CITIES (1965–67) PAPER 3 · SECTION B

Source B: From the official Report of the Kerner Commission, presented to President Johnson in March 1968

US Government Publishing Office

"Our nation is moving toward two societies, one black, one white—separate and unequal... Segregation and poverty have created in the racial ghetto a destructive environment totally unknown to white Americans. What white Americans have never fully understood—but what the Negro can never forget—is that white society is deeply implicated in the ghetto. White institutions created it, white institutions maintain it, and white society condones it. Pervasive discrimination in employment and housing, coupled with routine police harassment, has generated a reservoir of frustration that ignited in Watts, Newark, and Detroit."

Provenance: From the official findings of the National Advisory Commission on Civil Disorders (the Kerner Commission), established by President Lyndon B. Johnson to investigate urban riots.

Source C: From a speech by Stokely Carmichael, chairman of SNCC, addressing a rally in Chicago, July 1966

Student Nonviolent Coordinating Committee Papers

"We have been begging the white man for freedom for over a century, singing 'We Shall Overcome' while his police beat our heads and his judges throw us in jail. Non-violence has failed to protect Black people in the northern slums. The Civil Rights Act did not give our brothers jobs; it did not tear down the rats and roaches in Harlem and Chicago! Black Power means Black people coming together to organize our own strength. If white police come into our communities acting like an occupying army, Black men have a duty to defend themselves and take control of our own destiny."

Provenance: Speech by SNCC leader Stokely Carmichael delivered to an audience of urban Black youths in Chicago, widely broadcast across national media.

Interpretation 1

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Harvard Sitkoff, 'The Struggle for Black Equality, 1954–1980' (1981):

"The explosion of urban rebellions in Watts, Chicago, Newark, and Detroit was the direct consequence of intolerable economic despair and de facto segregation in northern ghettos. While the civil rights movement had won voting rights in the South, it had done almost nothing to alleviate poverty, dilapidated tenement housing, and 30% youth unemployment in northern cities. Confined by bank redlining and landlord discrimination into overcrowded slums, and subjected to routine brutality by almost entirely white police forces, young Black urbanites felt completely excluded from American prosperity. The riots were spontaneous eruptions of economic rage against living conditions that legislative civil rights acts had left untouched."

Interpretation 2

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Clayborne Carson, 'In Struggle: SNCC and the Black Awakening of the 1960s' (1981):

"The wave of urban violence from 1965 onwards was driven primarily by a profound ideological transformation: the rise of Black Power and militant Black nationalism. Inspired by the uncompromising rhetoric of Malcolm X and popularized by Stokely Carmichael, younger activists completely rejected Martin Luther King's philosophy of non-violence and interracial integration. Black Power taught urban youth that non-violence was humiliating and ineffective, encouraging them instead to confront white institutional power directly. The fiery speeches of SNCC and Black Panther leaders gave voice and political legitimacy to rebellion, transforming street unrest into conscious acts of defiance against white authority."

Enquiry Core: Source B & C provide contemporary primary evidence; Interpretations 1 & 2 provide competing modern historical views. Keep Page 5 open for Q3(a)–(d)

Spend approx. 12 minutes on Question 3(a). Evaluate content, provenance (COP), and context.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the causes of the riots in northern and western cities between 1965 and 1967? (8)

Contextual Knowledge: Reference the Watts Riots (Aug 1965, 34 dead, \$40m damage), Detroit & Newark (1967), Kerner Report recommendations, and the rise of the Black Panthers.

[illegible]

SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C)

Spend approx. 5 minutes on Q3(b) and 5 minutes on Q3(c). Write in concise, focused prose.

Q3(B) & Q3(C): INTERPRETATIONS [8M]

3 (b) Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main cause of the urban riots between 1965 and 1967. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations. (4)

Direct Contrast Frame: *Interpretation 1 argues that... whereas Interpretation 2 argues that...*

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3 (c) Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the main cause of the urban riots between 1965 and 1967. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4)

Different Views Frame: *The historians give different views because they have relied on different sources/evidence. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which emphasizes... whereas Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which emphasizes...*

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Spend approx. 25 minutes on Question 3(d). 16 marks for content + 4 marks for SPaG.

3 (d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 about the causes of the riots in northern and western cities between 1965 and 1967? (16 + 4 SPaG)

- Points in Int 1 that are valid
- Evidence from Source B supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Alternative counter-argument in Int 2
- Evidence from Source C supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Socio-economic deprivation (Watts, ghetto slums, bank redlining, 30%+ youth unemployment)
- Ideological radicalisation (Black Power, Malcolm X, Stokely Carmichael, rejection of non-violence)
- Police brutality as the immediate trigger (white police forces acting as occupying armies in ghettos)

Paragraph 1: Evaluate Interpretation 1 with precise own knowledge → Paragraph 2: Evaluate Interpretation 2 with precise own knowledge.

This image shows a full page of primary-ruled notebook paper. It features ten sets of horizontal lines across the page. Each set consists of three lines: a solid top line, a dashed middle line, and a solid bottom line. The lines are evenly spaced and extend from the left margin to the right edge of the page. There are no vertical lines or other markings present.

SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(D) (CONTINUED)

Complete your synthesis and reach a weighed, criteria-based conclusion.

Q3(D): CONCLUSION & JUDGEMENT

Conclusion Rule: State explicitly *how far* you agree using your chosen criteria. Do not merely summarize.

SPaG Check: Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. SCLC, Supreme Court, Vietcong).

[illegible]

PEARSON EDEXCEL LEVEL 4 MARK SCHEME [13–16 MARKS + 4 SPAG = 17–20 MARKS]:

- ☐
- Both Interpretations Weighed
- ☐
- Extensive Contextual Facts
- ☐
- Sustained Evaluative Criteria
- ☐
- Flawless SPaG & Specialist Terms

Exhaustive specification coverage. Practice an alternative high-yield exam question for this Key Topic.

4 Explain why the Black Panther Party was formed in Oakland, California, in 1966.

You may use the following in your answer:

- (You must also use information of your own.)*

Oakland, California (Oct 1966)

Oakland, California (Oct 1966) Ten-Point Programme

Armed citizen patrols (Mule law) Black leather jackets & berets

Free Breakfast for Children Free health clinics & sickle cell screening

- **P1:** Founding & Leadership: Huey Newton and Bobby Seale establishing the party to protect Black communities from police violence.

- **P2:** Armed Community Defense: Patrolling streets with law books and loaded firearms to monitor police stops and deter abuse.

- **P3:** Community Survival Programs (Own Knowledge): The Ten-Point Programme providing Free Breakfast for Children, shoes, and free medical clinics.

SECTION C: HIGH-SCORING EXEMPLAR RESPONSES • SECTION A

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 & Level 4 continuous prose models with examiner annotations.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q1 & Q2

QUESTION 1: SOURCE INFERENCE EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 2 (4/4)

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the methods used by Southern police against civil rights demonstrators in Birmingham, Alabama (1963).

(i) What I can infer: I can infer that Southern police forces used extreme, military-grade physical violence against unarmed young demonstrators. Details in the source that tell me this: The source states that police directed high-pressure water hoses that were "powerful enough to strip bark from trees" and "blast girls against brick walls".

(ii) What I can infer: I can infer that police authorities deliberately weaponized vicious animals to terrorize children into abandoning protests. Details in the source that tell me this: The source describes how Connor unleashed "snarling police attack dogs on leashes, which lunged into the crowds, biting several unarmed boys".

Examiner Annotation: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Two fully valid inferences with direct textual quotations supporting each point.

QUESTION 2: CAUSATION ESSAY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 4 (12/12)

Explain why the Civil Rights Act was passed in 1964. (12 marks)

A primary catalyst for the passage of the 1964 Civil Rights Act was the national and international outrage generated by the Birmingham Campaign in May 1963. SCLC leader Martin Luther King Jr. deliberately chose Birmingham to expose the extreme violence of segregationist authorities. When Public Safety Commissioner Eugene 'Bull' Connor turned high-pressure fire hoses and vicious police dogs on marching schoolchildren, the scenes were broadcast across national television networks. This visual brutality horrified millions of northern white voters and severely damaged American diplomatic standing during the Cold War, forcing President John F. Kennedy to publicly announce comprehensive civil rights legislation on national television in June 1963.

Furthermore, the assassination of President Kennedy in November 1963 provided the crucial moral and emotional impetus needed to pass the bill. When Vice President Lyndon B. Johnson assumed the presidency, he skillfully utilized Kennedy's martyrdom to overcome legislative gridlock. Johnson addressed a joint session of Congress, proclaiming that "no memorial oration or eulogy could more eloquently honor President Kennedy's memory than the earliest possible passage of the civil rights bill." This emotional appeal made it politically toxic for moderate congressmen to oppose the legislation, transforming Kennedy's draft into an urgent national tribute.

Finally, the passage of the Act was secured by the immense public pressure generated by the March on Washington in August 1963, combined with President Johnson's legislative mastery. Over 250,000 peaceful demonstrators gathered at the Lincoln Memorial, where King delivered his iconic 'I Have a Dream' speech. This unprecedented mobilization proved that civil rights had become a mass national movement. When Southern Democratic senators launched a historic 54-day filibuster to block the bill, Johnson utilized his formidable Senate expertise to forge a bipartisan coalition with Republican minority leader Everett Dirksen. Together, they secured the two-thirds supermajority required to break the filibuster, signing the historic Act into law on 2 July 1964.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (12/12 Marks): Comprehensive 3-paragraph causal structure; fully explores Birmingham, Kennedy's assassination, and the March on Washington; excellent analytical connectives and historical precision.

SECTION C: SECTION B MODELS & FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS

Official Level 3 & Level 4 continuous prose models and high-frequency pitfalls to avoid.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q3 & TRAPS

QUESTION 3(A): SOURCE UTILITY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 3 (8/8)

Source B is highly useful because it provides official, authoritative evidence of the deep structural and economic causes of urban unrest. Commissioned by President Johnson following the devastating Detroit riots of 1967, the Kerner Report boldly concluded that "white society is deeply implicated in the ghetto." The content reveals that discriminatory employment, redlined housing, and routine police harassment created an explosive "reservoir of frustration." Its provenance as an official federal investigation gives it exceptional utility, as it represents the first time the US government officially acknowledged institutional white racism as the root cause of urban riots.

Source C is also extremely useful because it provides immediate eyewitness insight into the radical ideological mindset of young Black activists. In this July 1966 Chicago speech, SNCC leader Stokely Carmichael explicitly repudiates Martin Luther King's philosophy of Christian non-violence, arguing that the 1964 Civil Rights Act brought no tangible improvements to northern slums. The utility of Source C lies in showing how the slogan of 'Black Power' gave political legitimacy to urban street rebellion, framing riots not as senseless crime but as legitimate self-defense against white police acting as an "occupying army." Combined with contextual knowledge of the Watts Riots (August 1965, 34 killed) and the rise of the Black Panther Party in 1966, both sources are invaluable: Source B exposes the underlying socio-economic tinderbox, while Source C explains the ideological spark that ignited it.

Examiner Annotation: Level 3 (8/8 Marks): *Perceptive evaluation of content, provenance, and historical context; contrasts structural socio-economic causes with political/ideological drivers.*

QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C): INTERPRETATIONS EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 2 (4/4 + 4/4)

Q3(b) Difference: The main difference is that Interpretation 1 views the riots as spontaneous explosions of rage caused by severe socio-economic misery, poverty, and de facto ghetto segregation, whereas Interpretation 2 argues that the violence was primarily driven by an ideological transformation centered on Black Power, Malcolm X's militant rhetoric, and the rejection of non-violence. Interpretation 1 focuses on 30% youth unemployment and slum housing, while Interpretation 2 emphasizes that leaders like Stokely Carmichael gave urban youth the ideological justification to rebel against white authority.

Q3(c) Reason: Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views because the historians have investigated different bodies of historical evidence. The author of Interpretation 1 has relied on government sociological investigations such as the Kerner Report in Source B, which methodically documented housing redlining, poverty, and unemployment statistics. Conversely, the author of Interpretation 2 has examined the militant political speeches and publications of SNCC and the Black Panthers, such as Source C, which highlighted the popular rejection of non-violence and the adoption of armed self-defense.

Examiner Annotation: Q3b: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): *Direct, accurate contrast between socio-economic and ideological arguments with detailed evidence from both extracts.* | Q3c: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): *Clear, historically grounded explanation linking differing viewpoints to differing source types and research perspectives.*

QUESTION 3(D): EVALUATIVE ESSAY CONCLUSION MODEL

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 4 (16+4 = 20/20)

In conclusion, I agree with Interpretation 1 to a very large extent, because grinding economic deprivation and police brutality were the fundamental root causes of urban unrest. The civil rights legislation of 1964 and 1965 had dismantled legal Jim Crow in the South, but it left the de facto economic apartheid of northern cities untouched. In Watts, Detroit, and Newark, Black citizens were trapped in redlined slums with substandard schools, astronomical youth unemployment, and routine abuse by all-white police forces. While Interpretation 2 correctly identifies that Black Power rhetoric (championed by Malcolm X and Stokely Carmichael) provided an ideological language for rebellion, Black Power was a symptom and an accelerator of urban despair rather than its primary cause. Without the unbearable material conditions documented in the Kerner Report, the calls for militant defiance in Source C would have found no receptive audience. Therefore, socio-economic frustration was the decisive powder keg, and police harassment was the trigger that set it off.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (16+4 = 20/20 Marks): *Exemplary evaluative conclusion; sustains explicit criteria; integrates both interpretations with deep factual knowledge; clearly establishes primary causation.*

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KEY TOPIC 2

• Riots were NOT caused by Southern Jim Crow laws

Northern and western riots (Watts, Detroit, Newark) occurred in cities with NO legal de jure segregation. They were driven by de facto segregation: redlining, jobs, and police brutality.

• Do NOT confuse Black Power with Black Panthers

Black Power was a broad political philosophy popularised by Stokely Carmichael in 1966. The Black Panther Party was a specific revolutionary organization founded by Huey Newton and Bobby Seale.

• The Kerner Report blamed WHITE society, not rioters

Students often incorrectly write that the government blamed Black rioters. The Kerner Commission famously declared: "White society is deeply implicated in the ghetto. White institutions created it, white institutions maintain it."

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

CANDIDATE SURNAME

OTHER NAMES

CENTRE NUMBER

CANDIDATE NUMBER

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

HISTORY · PAPER 3: MODERN DEPTH STUDY

Time: 1 hour 20 minutes (Complete Mock) · 52 Marks (+4 SPaG)

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Key Topic 3: US Involvement in the Vietnam War, 1954–68

Comprehensive 12-Page Specification Practice Pack · 1954–1968

PAPER
REFERENCE

1H10/33

Instructions: Use black ink or ball-point pen. Fill in candidate details above.

- Answer ALL questions in Section A (Question 1 and Question 2).
- Answer ALL questions in Section B (Question 3(a), 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)).
- Read the Section B Historical Enquiry Dossier carefully on Page 5 before attempting Questions 3(a)–(d).

TOTAL MARKS

56

(52 + 4 SPaG)

Advice: Spend approx. 15 minutes on Section A Q1–Q2, and 60 minutes on Section B Q3(a)–(d). **SPaG:** 4 marks are awarded for spelling, punctuation, grammar, and specialist terms on Q3(d).

Q	TYPE	SPECIFICATION TOPIC FOCUS	PAGE	MARKS	AUDIT
SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER (COMPULSORY QUESTION 1 & QUESTION 2)					
Q1	INFERENCE	Source A: Ineffectiveness of US Aerial Bombing (Sheehan Report)	P2	[4]	☐ / 4
Q2	EXPLAIN WHY	Escalation of US Involvement under LBJ (1964–65)	P3–4	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & INTERPRETATIONS (INTEGRATED 36M + 4 SPAG)					
Dossier	ENQUIRY	Dossier: Failure of US Military Tactics (Sources B, C & Ints 1, 2)	P5	Dossier	☐ / Read
3 (a)	UTILITY	Sources B & C: Failure of US Military Tactics in Vietnam	P6	[8]	☐ / 8
3 (b)	DIFFERENCE	Interpretations 1 & 2: Main Difference on Why Tactics Failed	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (c)	REASON	Interpretations 1 & 2: Reasons for Difference in Historical Views	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (d)	ESSAY	Evaluative Essay: How Far Do You Agree with Interpretation 1?	P8–9	[20]	☐ / 20
4	DEPTH BOOSTER	Spec Depth: How Vietcong Launched the Tet Offensive (1968)	P10	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION C: GRADE 8/9 STANDARDS & EXAM TRAPS (SELF & PEER ASSESSMENT)					
Exemplars	SECTION A MODELS	Full Level 2 Model Q1 & Level 4 Model Q2 Essay + Examiner Marks	P11	Audit	☐ Verified
Exemplars	SECTION B MODELS	Full Level 3 Model Q3a, Q3b, Q3c & Level 4 Q3d Model + Top 3 Traps	P12	Audit	☐ Verified

Source A: From a battlefield dispatch by
American war correspondent Neil
Sheehan, published in the New York
Times, 1966

US National Archives • Records of the Military Assistance Command, Vietnam (MACV), Press Excerpts

"From the sky, South Vietnam looks like a scarred moonscape of bomb craters. American jet bombers streak over the tree canopy dropping thousands of tons of high explosives, napalm, and defoliants. Yet on the ground, the enemy remains virtually invisible. When our infantry sweeps through the smoking ruins of a village, the Vietcong have vanished into hidden underground tunnel complexes or merged seamlessly with the local peasants in neighboring rice fields. The bombing destroys ancestral homes and generates endless lines of bitter refugees, but it does not stop the enemy."

Provenance: War report written by journalist Neil Sheehan from South Vietnam, observing US aerial operations and search-and-destroy patrols.

1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about the effectiveness of American bombing tactics in South Vietnam (1965–68). (4)

(I) INFERENCE 1:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(II) INFERENCE 2:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

Candidate Response Lines:

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Spend approx. 15 minutes on Question 2. Construct three developed causal paragraphs.

Q2: CAUSATION ESSAY [12M]

2 Explain why US involvement in Vietnam escalated under President Johnson between 1964 and 1965. (12)

- **The Gulf of Tonkin incident (August 1964)**
- **The attack on the US base at Pleiku (February 1965)**

(You must also use information of your own.)

FACT BANK:

Domino Theory & containment

USS Maddox attacked

Gulf of Tonkin Resolution (blank check)

Pleiku mortar attack kills 8 Americans

Operation Rolling Thunder (March 1965)

3,500 US Marines land at Da Nang

Weakness of ARVN & Saigon regime

CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

A decisive turning point occurred when...

In response, Congress...

This escalation was accelerated by...

Consequently, ...

This directly resulted in...

Paragraph 1 Focus: Paragraph 1: Gulf of Tonkin Incident & Resolution — Alleged North Vietnamese torpedo boat attack giving LBJ congressional authority to wage war.

[illegible]

Complete Paragraph 2 and Paragraph 3 (Compulsory Own Knowledge).

Q2: CONTINUATION

Paragraph 3 Focus (Compulsory Own Knowledge): Paragraph 3: Troop Deployments & Da Nang (Own Knowledge) — Landing of 3,500 Marines in March 1965 to defend air bases, beginning full ground combat commitment.

[illegible]

☐ 3 Developed Causal Factors ☐ Beyond Stimulus Own Fact ☐ Explicit Connectives ☐ Sustained Analytical Focus

SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY DOSSIER

Read this archival dossier carefully. All questions in Section B (Questions 3a–3d) relate to these materials.

HISTORICAL ENQUIRY FOCUS: THE REASONS WHY US MILITARY TACTICS FAILED TO DEFEAT THE VIETCONG (1965–68) PAPER 3 · SECTION B

Source B: From combat memoirs by US Marine Lieutenant Philip Caputo, published in ‘A Rumor of War’ (1977)

Marine Corps Historical Center

"We were sent on ‘search and destroy’ patrols through dense jungle and steaming swamps. The strategy was simple: find the enemy, fix him, and destroy him with massive artillery and air strikes. But we could almost never locate him. The Vietcong fought on their own terms: a sudden burst of fire from concealed tree lines, a sniper round, or an explosive booby trap made from a recycled artillery shell and bamboo punji sticks. When we entered a village, we could not distinguish a friendly farmer by day from a guerrilla fighter by night. Frustrated soldiers burned thatched huts with Zippo lighters, turning the very peasants we were sent to defend into sworn enemies."

Provenance: Written by Philip Caputo, a US Marine lieutenant who commanded combat infantry units in South Vietnam in 1965–66.

Source C: From an interview with Vo Thi Mo, a female Vietcong guerrilla fighter in Cu Chi district, recorded in 1982

War Remnants Museum

"The Americans possessed immense firepower—jets, helicopters, tanks, and chemical poisons that destroyed our rice crops. But they did not know the forest, and they did not know our people. Beneath the soil, we built over two hundred kilometers of multi-level tunnels with barracks, hospitals, and weapons factories. When their planes bombed, we remained safe twenty feet underground. When their infantry advanced, our booby traps—punji stakes smeared with animal dung, tripwires, and toe-poppers—inflicted daily casualties and wrecked their nerves. We were fighting for our own homeland; their soldiers fought only because they were drafted."

Provenance: Oral history interview with a veteran Vietcong combatant who operated in the Cu Chi tunnel network throughout the war.

Interpretation 1

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Christian G. Appy, 'Working-Class War: American Combat Soldiers and Vietnam' (1993):

"American military tactics were fundamentally mismatched with the political realities of guerrilla warfare in Vietnam. General Westmoreland's strategy of ‘search and destroy’ relied on attrition—measuring progress through enemy ‘body counts’ rather than securing territory. Because US troops were dropped into hostile territory by helicopter and evacuated immediately after contact, they never established permanent security for South Vietnamese villagers. Furthermore, the massive reliance on indiscriminate firepower—napalm, defoliants (Agent Orange), and artillery—inflicted horrific civilian casualties, alienating the rural population and pushing thousands of previously neutral peasants into active support for the National Liberation Front."

Interpretation 2

HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Guenter Lewy, 'America in Vietnam' (1978):

"The failure of the American military effort was not primarily due to flawed US tactics, but to the extraordinary effectiveness, discipline, and strategic design of the communist insurgency. The Vietcong and North Vietnamese Army operated an exceptionally sophisticated underground logistics infrastructure. Their vast network of subterranean tunnels in Cu Chi and the Iron Triangle neutralized American air superiority. Moreover, the Vietcong enforced strict discipline, utilized terror ruthlessly to eliminate uncooperative village leaders, and benefited from an inexhaustible flow of Soviet and Chinese weapons down the Ho Chi Minh Trail. The tenacity and survival techniques of the communist cadres made them impervious to military defeat."

Enquiry Core: Source B & C provide contemporary primary evidence; Interpretations 1 & 2 provide competing modern historical views. Keep Page 5 open for Q3(a)–(d)

Spend approx. 12 minutes on Question 3(a). Evaluate content, provenance (COP), and context.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the reasons why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong (1965–68)? (8)

Contextual Knowledge: Explain Search and Destroy, Operation Rolling Thunder, Agent Orange, punji traps, Cu Chi tunnels, and the Ho Chi Minh Trail.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C)

Spend approx. 5 minutes on Q3(b) and 5 minutes on Q3(c). Write in concise, focused prose.

Q3(B) & Q3(C): INTERPRETATIONS [8M]

3 (b) Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations. (4)

Direct Contrast Frame: Interpretation 1 argues that... whereas Interpretation 2 argues that...

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3 (c) Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4)

Different Views Frame: The historians give different views because they have relied on different sources/evidence. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which emphasizes... whereas Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which emphasizes...

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Spend approx. 25 minutes on Question 3(d). 16 marks for content + 4 marks for SPaG.

3 (d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 about the reasons why US military tactics failed to defeat the Vietcong (1965–68)? (16 + 4 SPaG)

- Points in Int 1 that are valid
- Evidence from Source B supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Alternative counter-argument in Int 2
- Evidence from Source C supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Flawed US military tactics (Search and Destroy, body counts, Zippo raids, napalm/Agent Orange destroying villages)
- Guerrilla tactics & terrain advantages (Cu Chi tunnels, booby traps, lack of uniform, peasant concealment)
- External communist support (Ho Chi Minh Trail, Soviet and Chinese modern weapons, anti-aircraft guns)

[illegible]

Complete your synthesis and reach a weighed, criteria-based conclusion.

Q3(D): CONCLUSION & JUDGEMENT

Conclusion Rule: State explicitly *how far* you agree using your chosen criteria. Do not merely summarize.

SPaG Check: Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. SCLC, Supreme Court, Vietcong).

[illegible]

☐ Both Interpretations Weighed ☐ Extensive Contextual Facts ☐ Sustained Evaluative Criteria ☐ Flawless SPaG & Specialist Terms

Exhaustive specification coverage. Practice an alternative high-yield exam question for this Key Topic.

4 Explain why the Vietcong and North Vietnamese Army were able to launch the Tet Offensive in January 1968. (12)

(You must also use information of your own.)

Tet Lunar New Year holiday	31 January 1968 assault	84,000 communist troops
Attacks on 100+ cities & Saigon US Embassy		
Khe Sanh diversion drew US forces away		
Smuggled arms in coffins & vegetable carts		

- **P1:** Logistics & Supply Lines: The Ho Chi Minh Trail moving Soviet and Chinese heavy weapons and 84,000 troops south undetected.
- **P2:** Strategic Diversion at Khe Sanh: General Giap attacking the remote Marine base at Khe Sanh to lure US reserves away from major cities.
- **P3:** Tactical Surprise & Infiltration (Own Knowledge): Breaking the traditional holiday truce and smuggling weapons into Saigon in false-bottomed trucks.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are approximately 20 lines visible. The paper has a slightly textured appearance and is set against a dark background.

SECTION C: HIGH-SCORING EXEMPLAR RESPONSES • SECTION A

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 & Level 4 continuous prose models with examiner annotations.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q1 & Q2

QUESTION 1: SOURCE INFERENCE EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 2 (4/4)

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the effectiveness of American bombing tactics in South Vietnam (1965–68).

(i) What I can infer: I can infer that American aerial bombing caused vast physical destruction to the landscape but failed to destroy the enemy forces.

Details in the source that tell me this: The source describes the countryside as a "scarred moonscape of bomb craters" but notes that "on the ground, the enemy remains virtually invisible".

(ii) What I can infer: I can infer that heavy bombing was counter-productive because it turned the civilian population against the Americans.

Details in the source that tell me this: The source states that the bombing "destroys ancestral homes and generates endless lines of bitter refugees, but it does not stop the enemy".

Examiner Annotation: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Two accurate inferences directly grounded in the text, accompanied by precise supporting quotations.

QUESTION 2: CAUSATION ESSAY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 4 (12/12)

Explain why US involvement in Vietnam escalated under President Johnson between 1964 and 1965. (12 marks)

A major reason for the escalation of US involvement was the Gulf of Tonkin incident in August 1964. Following alleged North Vietnamese torpedo boat attacks against the destroyer USS Maddox in international waters, President Lyndon B. Johnson requested emergency powers from Congress. The resulting Gulf of Tonkin Resolution passed almost unanimously, granting Johnson the constitutional authority to "take all necessary measures to repel any armed attack against the forces of the United States." This effectively served as a functional declaration of war and a blank check, enabling the president to escalate military commitments without formal congressional debate.

Furthermore, escalation was triggered by the Vietcong attack on the American airbase at Pleiku in February 1965. A surprise mortar attack killed eight American servicemen and wounded over one hundred, destroying ten aircraft. Johnson felt compelled to respond decisively to prove American resolve and deter communist aggression, declaring that he would not let Saigon fall. Within days, Johnson authorized Operation Rolling Thunder—a sustained, multi-year aerial bombardment campaign targeting North Vietnamese military bases, supply routes, and rail lines across the 17th parallel.

Finally, the escalation to ground combat troops was driven by the catastrophic military weakness of the South Vietnamese Army (ARVN) and the immediate necessity to protect US air bases. General William Westmoreland warned Washington that the corrupt Saigon regime was on the verge of total military collapse. In March 1965, Johnson deployed 3,500 US Marines to land on the beaches of Da Nang to guard the American airfield. Once ground combat troops were committed to defensive duties, Westmoreland rapidly shifted their mission to aggressive 'search and destroy' patrols, causing US troop numbers to skyrocket to over 184,000 by the end of 1965.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (12/12 Marks): Comprehensive 3-part causal analysis; covers the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution, Pleiku/Rolling Thunder, and the Da Nang troop landings; clear analytical flow and strong factual support.

SECTION C: SECTION B MODELS & FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS

Official Level 3 & Level 4 continuous prose models and high-frequency pitfalls to avoid.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q3 & TRAPS

QUESTION 3(A): SOURCE UTILITY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 3 (8/8)

Source B is exceptionally useful because it provides an unvarnished firsthand account from an American combat officer detailing the fundamental operational flaws of search-and-destroy tactics. Lieutenant Philip Caputo reveals that despite massive air and artillery firepower, US troops could rarely locate the elusive guerrilla enemy, who dictated the terms of combat through sudden ambushes and homemade booby traps. Furthermore, Caputo highlights how the inability to distinguish guerrillas from innocent peasants led soldiers to burn thatched huts ("Zippo raids"), thereby alienating the very population the US intended to protect. The provenance gives it great value: written by a frontline combat officer with no reason to flatter high command, it offers authentic insight into soldier demoralization.

Source C is equally useful because it offers an invaluable primary perspective from the opposing side, explaining the subterranean tactics that neutralized American technological superiority. Vo Thi Mo describes how the Cu Chi tunnel network—stretching over 200 kilometers across multiple levels—enabled Vietcong fighters to survive heavy aerial bombardment, manufacture weapons, and live safely underground. Furthermore, she highlights the psychological power of low-tech booby traps (punji stakes) in wrecking American morale and emphasizes the deep motivation of fighting for one's homeland compared to conscripted US troops. Evaluated in the context of the Ho Chi Minh Trail and General Westmoreland's failed strategy of attrition, both sources are immensely useful: Source B exposes the tactical frustration and alienation caused by American search-and-destroy methods, while Source C demonstrates the extraordinary resilience and tactical ingenuity of the communist underground resistance.

Examiner Annotation: Level 3 (8/8 Marks): Perceptive evaluation of both sources; examines tactical failure vs guerrilla resilience; integrates provenance (nature, origin, purpose) and detailed contextual knowledge.

QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C): INTERPRETATIONS EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 2 (4/4 + 4/4)

Q3(b) Difference: The main difference is that Interpretation 1 attributes US failure to flawed American military strategies—specifically search-and-destroy, body counts, and the excessive use of firepower (napalm, Agent Orange) that turned the peasant population against the US. On the other hand, Interpretation 2 argues that failure was primarily caused by the extraordinary resilience, discipline, and subterranean tunnel engineering of the Vietcong, supported by Chinese and Soviet arms supplies down the Ho Chi Minh Trail.

Q3(c) Reason: Interpretations 1 and 2 differ because the historians have investigated different dimensions of the war. The author of Interpretation 1 has focused on American military command records and veteran testimonies like Source B, analyzing the failure of search-and-destroy tactics and the moral alienation of the Vietnamese peasantry. In contrast, the author of Interpretation 2 has focused on Vietnamese guerrilla engineering and communist military archives like Source C, evaluating the military effectiveness of the Cu Chi tunnel systems and the logistical resilience of the National Liberation Front.

Examiner Annotation: Q3b: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Direct, clear contrast of main viewpoints supported by specific details and terminology from both texts. | Q3c: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Sound historical explanation linking differing interpretations to differing source materials and historical focuses.

QUESTION 3(D): EVALUATIVE ESSAY CONCLUSION MODEL

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 4 (16+4 = 20/20)

In conclusion, I agree with Interpretation 1 to a very substantial extent, because the US military's reliance on conventional warfare and indiscriminate firepower was fundamentally self-defeating in a political counter-insurgency. As General Westmoreland pursued a strategy of attrition measured by 'body counts', American forces deployed 400,000 tons of napalm and millions of gallons of Agent Orange. As detailed in Source B, this destroyed villages and ancestral burial grounds, turning the civilian peasantry into active or passive supporters of the Vietcong. However, Interpretation 1 is incomplete without the critical factor highlighted in Interpretation 2. Flawed US tactics alone do not explain why the Vietcong could not be eradicated. As Source C proves, the communist forces possessed exceptional guerrilla discipline, an intricate subterranean infrastructure (the Cu Chi tunnels), and an uninterrupted supply of Soviet and Chinese armaments along the Ho Chi Minh Trail. Therefore, while American tactical blunders alienated the civilian population, it was the combination of flawed US strategy and superior guerrilla resilience that made military victory impossible.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (16+4 = 20/20 Marks): Nuanced, criteria-based evaluation; compares flawed US firepower against Vietcong tactical adaptability; demonstrates mastery of historical context.

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KEY TOPIC 3

• **Vietcong were NOT the North Vietnamese Army**
The Vietcong (National Liberation Front) were South Vietnamese communist guerrillas fighting in the south. The NVA (PAVN) were the regular army of communist North Vietnam.

• **Agent Orange was a DEFOLIANT, not a poison gas**
Agent Orange was a chemical herbicide designed to strip jungle foliage and expose guerrilla trails. Napalm was a sticky jellied petroleum incendiary bomb. Do not confuse them.

• **Search and Destroy measured SUCCESS BY BODY COUNT**
Unlike WWII, territory was not captured and held. US troops landed by helicopter, fought, counted dead enemy bodies, and evacuated, allowing the Vietcong to re-occupy the area immediately.

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

CANDIDATE SURNAME

OTHER NAMES

CENTRE NUMBER

CANDIDATE NUMBER

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

HISTORY · PAPER 3: MODERN DEPTH STUDY

Time: 1 hour 20 minutes (Complete Mock) · 52 Marks (+4 SPaG)

Option 33: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

Key Topic 4: The End of the Vietnam War, 1968–75

Comprehensive 12-Page Specification Practice Pack · 1968–1975

PAPER
REFERENCE

1H10/33

Instructions: Use black ink or ball-point pen. Fill in candidate details above.

- Answer ALL questions in Section A (Question 1 and Question 2).
- Answer ALL questions in Section B (Question 3(a), 3(b), 3(c), and 3(d)).
- Read the Section B Historical Enquiry Dossier carefully on Page 5 before attempting Questions 3(a)–(d).

TOTAL MARKS

56

(52 + 4 SPaG)

Advice: Spend approx. 15 minutes on Section A Q1–Q2, and 60 minutes on Section B Q3(a)–(d). **SPaG:** 4 marks are awarded for spelling, punctuation, grammar, and specialist terms on Q3(d).

Q	TYPE	SPECIFICATION TOPIC FOCUS	PAGE	MARKS	AUDIT
SECTION A: TIMED EXAM PAPER (COMPULSORY QUESTION 1 & QUESTION 2)					
Q1	INFERENCE	Source A: The Kent State University Shootings (May 1970)	P2	[4]	☐ / 4
Q2	EXPLAIN WHY	Why Nixon Introduced Vietnamization in 1969	P3–4	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & INTERPRETATIONS (INTEGRATED 36M + 4 SPAG)					
Dossier	ENQUIRY	Dossier: Growth of Anti-War Opposition (Sources B, C & Ints 1, 2)	P5	Dossier	☐ / Read
3 (a)	UTILITY	Sources B & C: Reasons for Growth of Anti-War Opposition	P6	[8]	☐ / 8
3 (b)	DIFFERENCE	Interpretations 1 & 2: Main Difference in Views on Anti-War Movement	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (c)	REASON	Interpretations 1 & 2: Reasons for Difference in Historical Views	P7	[4]	☐ / 4
3 (d)	ESSAY	Evaluative Essay: How Far Do You Agree with Interpretation 1?	P8–9	[20]	☐ / 20
4	DEPTH BOOSTER	Spec Depth: Why the Paris Peace Accords Were Signed (1973)	P10	[12]	☐ / 12
SECTION C: GRADE 8/9 STANDARDS & EXAM TRAPS (SELF & PEER ASSESSMENT)					
Exemplars	SECTION A MODELS	Full Level 2 Model Q1 & Level 4 Model Q2 Essay + Examiner Marks	P11	Audit	☐ Verified
Exemplars	SECTION B MODELS	Full Level 3 Model Q3a, Q3b, Q3c & Level 4 Q3d Model + Top 3 Traps	P12	Audit	☐ Verified

Source A: From a front-page eyewitness report in the Cleveland Plain Dealer, 5 May 1970

Kent State University Libraries • Special Collections and Archives, May 4 Collection

"The university commons was littered with tear gas canisters and screaming students fleeing in panic. Following days of intense student demonstrations protesting President Nixon's military invasion of Cambodia, the Ohio National Guard had been deployed with fixed bayonets. Without verbal warning, twenty-eight guardsmen abruptly halted, wheeled around, leveled their M1 military rifles at a crowd of unarmed students several hundred feet away, and fired a thirteen-second volley of sixty-seven shots. When the cordite cleared, four young students lay dead on the grass and nine were critically injured."

Provenance: Eyewitness newspaper dispatch reported from the Kent State campus the day following the shootings.

1 Give two things you can infer from Source A about the events at Kent State University in May 1970. (4)

(I) INFERENCE 1:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

(II) INFERENCE 2:

What I can infer from Source A:

Details in the source that tell me this:

Candidate Response Lines:

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2 Explain why President Richard Nixon introduced the policy of Vietnamization in 1969. (12)

You may use the following in your answer:

- Rising US casualties
- The impact of the Tet Offensive (1968)

(You must also use information of your own.)

FACT BANK:

14,000+ US deaths in 1968

Tet Offensive shattered victory claims

Credibility gap exposed

Walter Cronkite television verdict

Nixon election pledge: "Peace with Honor"

Build up ARVN combat strength

Withdraw 500,000 US troops

CAUSAL CONNECTIVES:

A fundamental reason was...

This was intensified by...

Consequently, Nixon was forced to...

Furthermore, ...

This policy aimed to...

Paragraph 1 Focus: Paragraph 1: Rising Casualties & Tet Trauma — Over 14,000 US combat deaths in 1968 shattered public faith in military victory.

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Complete Paragraph 2 and Paragraph 3 (Compulsory Own Knowledge).

Q2: CONTINUATION

Paragraph 3 Focus (Compulsory Own Knowledge): Paragraph 3: Strengthening the ARVN (Own Knowledge) — Equipping South Vietnamese forces with modern aircraft and artillery so US soldiers could leave.

This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwriting practice. It features approximately 20 horizontal rows. Each row is composed of three parallel lines: a solid top line, a dashed middle line, and a solid bottom line. The lines are evenly spaced and extend across the entire width of the page, providing a guide for letter height and placement. There is no text or other markings on the page.

☐ 3 Developed Causal Factors ☐ Beyond Stimulus Own Fact ☐ Explicit Connectives ☐ Sustained Analytical Focus

SECTION B: HISTORICAL ENQUIRY DOSSIER

Read this archival dossier carefully. All questions in Section B (Questions 3a–3d) relate to these materials.

HISTORICAL ENQUIRY FOCUS: THE MAIN REASON FOR THE GROWTH OF OPPOSITION TO THE VIETNAM WAR IN THE USA (1968–71) PAPER 3 · SECTION B

Source B: From a special television broadcast by CBS News anchor Walter Cronkite, 27 February 1968

CBS News Broadcast Archives

"It seems now more certain than ever that the bloody experience of Vietnam is to end in a stalemate. To say that we are closer to victory today is to believe, in the face of the evidence, the optimists who have been wrong in the past. To suggest we are on the edge of defeat is to yield to unreasonable despair. To say that we are mired in stalemate seems the only realistic, yet unsatisfactory, conclusion. It is increasingly clear to this reporter that the only rational way out will be to negotiate, not as victors, but as an honorable people who lived up to their pledge to defend democracy and did the best they could."

Provenance: Broadcast to millions of American households by the nation's most respected news anchor following his fact-finding mission to Vietnam after the Tet Offensive.

Source C: From an anti-draft flyer distributed by Students for a Democratic Society (SDS) at university campuses, October 1969

Wisconsin Historical Society

"Rich young men with political connections go to prestigious colleges and receive student deferments. Working-class and Black youth who cannot afford university are handed M16 rifles and shipped off to die in the jungles for a corrupt dictatorship in Saigon. Over 35,000 American boys have already come home in aluminum coffins, while Washington politicians lie about 'progress'. We refuse to participate in the slaughter of Vietnamese peasants. Burn your draft cards! Join the nationwide Moratorium on October 15! Strike against the war machine!"

Provenance: Protest pamphlet produced and circulated by the student anti-war organization Students for a Democratic Society (SDS) prior to the October 1969 Moratorium.

Interpretation 1 HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Chester Pach, 'The Real Media War on Vietnam' (1996):

"The fundamental engine driving mass opposition to the war was television journalism and the uncensored visual exposure of combat horrors. Vietnam was America's first 'living-room war'. Night after night, millions of ordinary Americans watched unedited color footage of wounded soldiers, burning huts, civilian body counts, and napalmed children alongside their evening dinners. When trusted national figures like Walter Cronkite declared the war unwinnable after the Tet Offensive, it shattered the government's credibility. The media's subsequent exposure of atrocities like the My Lai massacre in 1969 made it impossible for the moral conscience of middle America to support the war any longer."

Interpretation 2 HISTORIOGRAPHY

From Historian Melvin Small, 'Antiwarriors: The Vietnam War and the Battle for America's Hearts and Minds' (2002):

"While television coverage was vivid, the primary catalyst for mass domestic opposition was the personal, immediate threat posed by the military draft system combined with skyrocketing American casualties. Young men faced the terrifying prospect of conscription into an ambiguous conflict, producing a massive student rebellion across college campuses. Student organizations like SDS, energized by civil rights techniques, transformed anti-war sentiment into sustained street mobilization, draft-card burnings, and nationwide moratoriums involving millions of demonstrators. It was the visceral fear of the draft, coupled with the rising toll of over 50,000 American deaths, that galvanized grassroots resistance and made the war politically unsustainable."

Enquiry Core: Source B & C provide contemporary primary evidence; Interpretations 1 & 2 provide competing modern historical views. **Keep Page 5 open for Q3(a)–(d)**

Spend approx. 12 minutes on Question 3(a). Evaluate content, provenance (COP), and context.

3 (a) Study Sources B and C. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War in the USA (1968–71)? (8)

Contextual Knowledge: Reference the Tet Offensive (1968), the My Lai Massacre revelations (Nov 1969), the Draft Lottery (Dec 1969), and the Kent State shootings (May 1970).

[illegible]

SECTION B: TIMED EXAM PAPER • QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C)

Spend approx. 5 minutes on Q3(b) and 5 minutes on Q3(c). Write in concise, focused prose.

Q3(B) & Q3(C): INTERPRETATIONS [8M]

3 (b) Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War. What is the main difference between these views? Explain your answer, using details from both interpretations. (4)

Direct Contrast Frame: *Interpretation 1 argues that... whereas Interpretation 2 argues that...*

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3 (c) Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer. (4)

Different Views Frame: *The historians give different views because they have relied on different sources/evidence. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which emphasizes... whereas Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which emphasizes...*

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Spend approx. 25 minutes on Question 3(d). 16 marks for content + 4 marks for SPaG.

3 (d) How far do you agree with Interpretation 1 about the main reason for the growth of opposition to the Vietnam War in the USA (1968–71)? (16 + 4 SPaG)

- Points in Int 1 that are valid
- Evidence from Source B supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Alternative counter-argument in Int 2
- Evidence from Source C supporting this
- Specific contextual knowledge backing it

- Media coverage & credibility gap (Living-room war, Walter Cronkite, My Lai massacre exposed in 1969)
- The draft & student protest (Conscription threat, draft card burnings, SDS, Kent State shootings 1970)
- Casualties & economic strain (58,000+ total US deaths, runaway inflation, veterans joining protests (VVAW))

Paragraph 1: Evaluate Interpretation 1 with precise own knowledge → Paragraph 2: Evaluate Interpretation 2 with precise own knowledge.

[illegible]

Complete your synthesis and reach a weighed, criteria-based conclusion.

Conclusion Rule: State explicitly *how far* you agree using your chosen criteria. Do not merely summarize.

[illegible]☐ Both Interpretations Weighed ☐ Extensive Contextual Facts ☐ Sustained Evaluative Criteria ☐ Flawless SPaG & Specialist Terms

Exhaustive specification coverage. Practice an alternative high-yield exam question for this Key Topic.

4 Explain why the Paris Peace Accords were signed in January 1973.

You may use the following in your answer:

- (You must also use information of your own.)*

Operation Linebacker II (Christmas Bombings)

40,000 tons of bombs on Hanoi & Haiphong

Nixon visit to Beijing (Feb 1972) & Moscow (May 1972)

Henry Kissinger and Le Duc Tho talks

Complete withdrawal of US troops in 60 days Return of all American POWs

- **P1:** Superpower Diplomacy & Détente: Nixon's diplomatic breakthroughs in Beijing and Moscow pressuring North Vietnam to negotiate.

- **P2:** Operation Linebacker II: The devastating 11-day Christmas bombing forcing Hanoi back to the negotiating table.

- **P3:** American Domestic Pressure (Own Knowledge): The US public's absolute exhaustion with the war and congressional threats to cut funding.

SECTION C: HIGH-SCORING EXEMPLAR RESPONSES • SECTION A

Official Pearson Edexcel Level 2 & Level 4 continuous prose models with examiner annotations.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q1 & Q2

QUESTION 1: SOURCE INFERENCE EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 2 (4/4)

Give two things you can infer from Source A about the events at Kent State University in May 1970.

(i) What I can infer: I can infer that the National Guard used lethal, completely disproportionate military force against unarmed university students. Details in the source that tell me this: The source notes that guardsmen "leveled their M1 military rifles at a crowd of unarmed students... and fired a thirteen-second volley of sixty-seven shots", killing four.

(ii) What I can infer: I can infer that the student demonstrations were a direct response to President Nixon's military expansion of the Vietnam War. Details in the source that tell me this: The source explains that the students were protesting "President Nixon's military invasion of Cambodia".

Examiner Annotation: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Two valid inferences with direct, accurate textual evidence quoted from the source.

QUESTION 2: CAUSATION ESSAY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS • LEVEL 4 (12/12)

Explain why President Richard Nixon introduced the policy of Vietnamization in 1969. (12 marks)

A primary reason for introducing Vietnamization was the unsustainable toll of American casualties combined with the psychological shock of the Tet Offensive in 1968. Over 14,000 American soldiers were killed in 1968 alone, bringing total US combat deaths past 30,000. The Tet Offensive thoroughly demolished the Johnson administration's claims that victory was near, creating an irreparable 'credibility gap' in the minds of the American public. When CBS anchor Walter Cronkite declared the war mired in a bloody stalemate, public support for maintaining massive US troop deployments collapsed, convincing incoming President Nixon that the war had become politically unwinnable with American ground forces.

Furthermore, Nixon introduced Vietnamization to fulfill his central 1968 presidential election campaign promise of achieving "peace with honor." Nixon understood that immediate, unilateral withdrawal would be seen as an ignominious defeat, damaging America's Cold War credibility and leading to the immediate communist takeover of South Vietnam. Vietnamization was designed as a strategic compromise: it allowed Nixon to systematically de-escalate domestic anti-war fury by withdrawing American conscripts, while transferring ground combat responsibilities to the South Vietnamese army (ARVN) so the US did not appear to be surrendering.

Finally, Vietnamization was made feasible by a massive program to re-equip and modernize the ARVN into a self-sufficient fighting force. The United States poured billions of dollars of modern military hardware into South Vietnam, providing over one million M16 rifles, armored vehicles, heavy artillery, and the world's fourth-largest air force. Between 1969 and 1972, Nixon withdrew over 500,000 American troops while relying heavily on US air power to support ARVN ground operations. This enabled Nixon to dramatically reduce US casualties while maintaining military pressure on North Vietnam during peace negotiations in Paris.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (12/12 Marks): Outstanding causal analysis; explores casualties/Tet, Nixon's domestic political strategy, and ARVN modernization; rich factual detail and sophisticated historical terminology.

SECTION C: SECTION B MODELS & FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS

Official Level 3 & Level 4 continuous prose models and high-frequency pitfalls to avoid.

GRADE 8/9 MODELS: Q3 & TRAPS

QUESTION 3(A): SOURCE UTILITY EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 3 (8/8)

Source B is exceptionally useful because it provides direct evidence of how influential national television journalists helped turn middle-class public opinion against the war. Walter Cronkite was universally regarded as "the most trusted man in America." When he broadcast his personal verdict on 27 February 1968 stating that the war was "mired in stalemate" and that negotiation was the only rational exit, it dealt a catastrophic blow to government claims of military progress. The utility of Source B lies in its massive national reach: President Johnson famously remarked, "If I've lost Cronkite, I've lost middle America." This demonstrates how televised editorial commentary legitimized anti-war views among ordinary, previously patriotic citizens.

Source C is equally useful because it offers direct insight into the intense grievances driving the youth and student anti-war movement. Circulated by Students for a Democratic Society (SDS) in October 1969, the leaflet reveals how the military draft was viewed as deeply discriminatory, forcing working-class and Black youth to die in "aluminum coffins" while wealthy students secured college deferments. The provenance makes it particularly valuable: as an authentic organizing pamphlet for the historic nationwide Moratorium of October 1969 (which mobilized over two million protesters), it shows how student radicals actively channeled fear of conscription into civil disobedience and draft-card burnings. When contextualized alongside the horrific revelations of the My Lai massacre in November 1969 and the Kent State shootings in May 1970, both sources are highly useful: Source B shows how television destroyed government credibility for middle America, while Source C demonstrates how the threat of the draft radicalized American youth.

Examiner Annotation: Level 3 (8/8 Marks): Exceptional evaluation of both sources; analyzes media influence vs the military draft; thoroughly investigates nature, origin, purpose, and detailed contextual knowledge.

QUESTION 3(B) & 3(C): INTERPRETATIONS EXEMPLAR

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 2 (4/4 + 4/4)

Q3(b) Difference: The main difference is that Interpretation 1 views the growth of anti-war opposition as primarily driven by television journalism and visual media exposure of combat atrocities (such as Walter Cronkite's broadcast and the My Lai massacre), whereas Interpretation 2 argues that opposition was primarily fueled by the personal, immediate threat of the military draft system, rising US casualties, and direct student activism on university campuses.

Q3(c) Reason: Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views because the historians have investigated different dimensions of the anti-war movement. The author of Interpretation 1 has focused on television network archives and media reception studies like Source B, analyzing how broadcast coverage of combat created a credibility gap for middle-class Americans. In contrast, the author of Interpretation 2 has examined university archives, protest leaflets like Source C, and draft resistance statistics, focusing on how conscription and rising body counts mobilized American college youth.

Examiner Annotation: Q3b: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Clear, direct contrast between media-driven and draft/casualty-driven arguments with specific supporting details from both extracts. | Q3c: Level 2 (4/4 Marks): Fully developed explanation connecting differing historical viewpoints to differing evidence types and historical focuses.

QUESTION 3(D): EVALUATIVE ESSAY CONCLUSION MODEL

FULL MARKS · LEVEL 4 (16+4 = 20/20)

In conclusion, I agree with Interpretation 1 to a moderate extent, but I find Interpretation 2 to provide a more fundamental explanation for the growth of mass opposition. Television coverage was undeniably revolutionary; as America's first 'living-room war', uncensored nightly broadcasts of napalm attacks, burning villages, and Walter Cronkite's editorial verdict shattered government propaganda and alienated middle America. However, television images alone would not have sustained years of massive street resistance without the personal, visceral catalyst identified in Interpretation 2: the military draft. Conscription forced millions of young American men to confront the reality that they could be legally compelled to die in an ambiguous war. This personal threat, combined with the grim return of over 50,000 body bags, transformed passive moral unease into militant student strikes, draft-card burnings, and the Moratorium protests seen in Source C. When the Ohio National Guard killed four students at Kent State in 1970, it provoked strikes across 400 campuses, proving that conscription and youth radicalism were the driving engines of the anti-war movement. Therefore, while television exposed the horrors of war, it was the draft and casualties that made the war intolerable.

Examiner Annotation: Level 4 (16+4 = 20/20 Marks): Authoritative evaluative essay; establishes clear criteria comparing media exposure against conscription and casualties; demonstrates profound mastery of the Edexcel specification.

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KEY TOPIC 4

- **Vietnamization was NOT an immediate withdrawal**

Nixon withdrew US ground combat troops gradually over 4 years (1969–73) while vastly INCREASING aerial bombing (Operation Linebacker) and invading Cambodia and Laos.
- **The Draft was NOT equal across social classes**

Until the 1969 draft lottery, wealthy and middle-class youths received college deferments, meaning working-class and Black Americans were disproportionately drafted and killed.
- **Kent State occurred because of the CAMBODIA invasion**

The May 1970 Kent State protests were specifically triggered by President Nixon's surprise television announcement that US forces had invaded neighboring Cambodia.